

ATHREYA KANNAN

Washington, DC 20002 | (646)-701-2394 | ak5083@columbia.edu | linkedin.com/in/athreyakannan

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY:

Energy and finance professional with 5+ years of experience across project finance, financial modeling, business operations, and energy infrastructure in the United States, Africa, South Asia, and the Caribbean. Proven track record building complex Excel-based financial models, including cash flow projections, DSCR analysis, NPV/IRR calculations, viability gap assessments, and debt sizing, for energy, water, and infrastructure projects financed by multilateral development banks and private investors. Also skilled in using AI coding assistants to build custom financial analysis tools that support these workflows. Experienced in compliance reporting, lender coordination, and decarbonization strategy for utility-scale energy clients.

CORE COMPETENCIES:

- Renewable Energy Project Finance
 - Financial Planning & Analysis (FP&A)
 - Greenhouse Gas Accounting, LEED GA
- Advanced Excel & Financial Modeling
 - PPA/EPC Agreements
 - AI-Assisted Modeling & Workflow Design
- DSCR/NPV/IRR Analysis
 - ESG-linked Fund Management
 - Tableau, Power BI, MS Office

EDUCATION:

Columbia University | New York City, USA

Master of Science in Sustainability Management

Coursework: Impact Finance, Cost-Benefit Analysis, Energy Markets and Innovation, Financing the Clean Energy Economy, Solar Project Development, GHG Emissions Accounting, Corporate Sustainability Reporting, Life Cycle Assessment, Sustainable Cities, Climate Change Law & Policy

SP Jain School of Global Management | Sydney, Australia

Bachelor of Business Administration

Coursework: Corporate Finance, Financial Risk Analysis and Modeling, Accounting, Microeconomics and Macroeconomics, Corporate Social Responsibility

August 2023 - December 2024

September 2016 - May 2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

Castalia LLC | Washington DC, USA

Senior Analyst – Energy & Infrastructure Project Finance

- Coordinated with multilateral stakeholders (**World Bank, AfDB, CDB, IDB**) to advance transaction execution for renewable energy and water infrastructure projects across multiple **Caribbean and African markets**, building debt sizing, capital structuring, cash flow models, and energy modeling using tools like Helioscope
- Performed FP&A for electricity and water utilities, developing **financial turnaround strategies, conducting comprehensive cost-of-service studies, and advising on energy sector policy and regulatory reforms.**
- Led development of a \$60,000 **web-based financial modeling tool using AI-assisted coding** for the World Bank's Global Water Security and Sanitation Partnership (GWSP), enabling **financing-gap analysis** across **90 countries**
- Built a **Renewable Energy Readiness Index** tracking renewable energy targets across **15 CARICOM countries**, and developed an **economic model** for a **\$500,000 AfDB-backed infrastructure contract in South Africa**
- Structured a PPP-based financing framework for Mozambique's national water utility (FIPAG), part of the **country's \$1.8B national water investment program**, assessing viability gap funding needs and aligning with Green Climate Fund eligibility criteria

WSP Global Inc. | New York City, USA

Sustainability Intern – Built Ecology

- Modeled greenhouse gas emissions** through 2050 across WMATA's full transit network (1,500+ vehicle fleet, regional rail and bus operations) and assessed viability gap funding needs to support the agency's **Net Zero Plan and decarbonization strategy**
- Conducted energy modeling** (IES VE) and **Life Cycle Assessments** (Tally) to evaluate LEED and WELL certification performance for utility-scale transit infrastructure projects, supporting sustainable design compliance

Climake | New York City, USA

Financial Modeling Intern – Venture Capital

- Built project-level financial models and supported transaction execution, deal-flow due diligence, market sizing, and capital raising for **CoolPact Capital, a \$100M climate-tech VC fund** (targeting a \$50M first close) investing in emerging-market renewable cooling solutions, coordinating with investment and portfolio teams to track key assumptions
- Modeled debt financing structures, joint venture terms, and conversion scenarios** for portfolio companies, evaluating capital structuring, debt sizing, and blended finance implications, including concessional equity structures to crowd in private capital, to support investor negotiations and financing decisions

Shastha NDT Services | Mumbai, India

Contracts & Financial Analyst

- Negotiated and closed **15-year, \$2 million-plus business-to-business (B2B) infrastructure contracts**, securing long-term revenue streams and strengthening client retention
- Built **cash flow forecasts, profit and loss models, and variance analyses** to guide capital allocation decisions on long-term infrastructure investments

Zip Co | Sydney, Australia

Customer Relationship Specialist

- Resolved 3,000+ customer conflicts, **reducing average resolution time by 67%** (from 72+ hours to under 24 hours), and cut bill payment **processing time by 33%** (from 24 hours to ~16 hours) by launching the inaugural Zip Bills program in collaboration with Visa
- Pitched **spend-tracking software integration** to CEO Larry Diamond; adopted company-wide in January 2023

October 2024 - Present

May 2024 - August 2024

February 2024 - May 2024

September 2022 - July 2023

January 2021 - August 2022

CLIENT DRIVEN ACADEMIC PROJECTS:

Fresh Supply (Capstone), Project Manager | Chicago, USA (Remote)

- Led a team of 15 graduate student consultants as project manager, setting strategic priorities **and coordinating cross-functional workstreams** for a capstone consulting engagement with client Fresh Supply, aligning program delivery with client business objectives
- Developed the FRESH framework, a **strategic model for planning e-waste collection and refurbishing campaigns** globally, to bridge the digital divide and expand smart device access for underserved communities and performed impact analysis to assess campaign cost savings and social return on investment

CMA CGM, Net Impact | Miami, USA (Remote)

- Evaluated **clean fuel technology** investment opportunities for a **\$1.5B Energy Fund**, conducting **due diligence and financial analysis** to support capital allocation decisions
- Assessed **carbon footprint** of a global shipping conglomerate representing **19.9% market share of the global shipping industry**, informing emissions-reduction and **decarbonization strategy**

Jonis Realty | New York City, USA

- Built a **Greenhouse Gas (GHG) Inventory for a 48-property real estate portfolio** across New York City, quantifying energy consumption and emissions data to **support regulatory compliance**
- Recommended emission reduction strategies using SBTi and GRI frameworks, incorporating **financing and cost-benefit analysis of energy efficiency retrofits to inform decarbonization budgeting and capital allocation decisions**

September 2024 - December 2024

September 2024 - December 2024

September 2023 - December 2023

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY SERVICE:

- Vice President** (Current) | Rotaract Club of DC, Washington, DC: Leading professional development and social service projects
- Event Manager** (2024) | United Nations, Columbia, NYC: Planned grassroots events with local green leaders
- Co-founder** (2019-20) | Baked, a food and beverage startup: Led financial planning, budgeting, and investor relations
- President** (2021-22) | Rotaract Club of Burwood, Sydney: Spearheaded multiple impactful donations and COVID relief projects